

THE DABBLER'S RISK

Your AI SaaS doesn't have a churn problem.

It has a tourist problem.

TOURIST VS RESIDENT

Tourist: tries 100 AI tools a year, signs up, pokes around, leaves.

Resident: picks 3, builds their workflow around them.



YOU'RE OPTIMIZING FOR THE WRONG ONE

Most founders design their funnel to attract tourists — without realizing it.

SIGNALS YOU'RE ATTRACTING TOURISTS

- Signups trending up
- 30-day retention below 20%
- 'Time to value' metrics look great
- Revenue doesn't compound

ACTIVATION HIGH. RESIDENCY ZERO.

**The two numbers look different on a dashboard.
They're the same failure.**

RESIDENTS DON'T STAY FOR FEATURES

They stay for:

- Workflows they can't rebuild elsewhere
- Data they've invested in
- Habits you've helped form
- Networks they've connected to

**FEATURE DEFENSIBILITY DIES. BEHAVIOR
DEFENSIBILITY COMPOUNDS.**

One is a snapshot. The other is a moat.

STOP MEASURING ACTIVATION. START MEASURING RESIDENCY.

% of signups still logging in at week 12+.

That number is your actual business.

AT \$100K ARR, RESIDENCY IS UNDER 8%

That's the Dabbler's Risk.

The math breaks inside 18 months.

Positioning selects for residents before signup.

Onboarding can't fix what the funnel let in.

Follow @muddassir for retention systems for AI founders.